Ananya Mahadi

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Education

University of California, San Diego — La Jolla, CA
Bachelor of Science in Cognitive Science, Specialization in Design and Interaction — Sep 2025 – June 2028
Minor in Entrepreneurship & Technology
GPA: 3.77
Relevant coursework: Cognitive Consequences in Technology, Usability & Information Architecture, Information Visualization, Interaction Design

Experience

User Onboarding & Product Research Intern — Remote
ThoughtGPS — May 2026 – Aug 2026
- Redesigned the Near Me experience in the ThoughtGPS Creator app, including pin states, filters, and dark mode, so locations are easier to scan and narrow down
- Ran user research and usability testing to find onboarding friction, then worked with product and UI/UX teams to turn user feedback into design changes

UX Researcher, Client Project: San Diego Coastkeeper — Remote
DesignCo at UC San Diego — June 2026 – Sep 2026
- Led UX research (surveys, interviews, competitive analysis) for a nonprofit education website redesign, identifying barriers in content findability and accessibility that shaped the redesigned prototype
- A/B tested the prototype against the live site with 15 participants, raising education findability from 60% to 87% and video/curriculum discovery from 73% to 87%

Vice President of Design — Hybrid
AI Student Collective at UC San Diego — Nov 2025 – June 2026
- Led visual branding and UX design for AI-focused projects and events
- Designed digital content and interfaces communicating AI ethics, applications, and workflows to student audiences

Product Advisor — Hybrid
Product Management Club at UC San Diego — May 2026 – Present
- Conduct client outreach and support partnership development, managing client onboarding and communication
- Mentor members interested in product management, design, and development

Projects

Sakura - Pink Tax Alternative Finder App — May 2026
- Conducted user research (160+ survey responses) and competitive analysis to validate demand for a mobile app helping low-income women identify fair-priced alternatives to gender-marked “pink tax” products
- Designed and prototyped the app in Figma with 3 collaborators, including an item finder, ingredient/price comparison tool, and savings-tracking feature to drive habit change

Mental Health America Website Redesign - Design for America at UC San Diego — Sep 2025 – Jan 2026
- Redesigned the Mental Health America website in Figma with a 4-person team, building a consistent grid and spacing system to reduce visual clutter
- Applied human-centered design principles as designated UX Designer; gained hands-on wireframing and prototyping experience

Skills

- **Design & Prototyping**: Figma, Adobe Creative Cloud, Canva, Prototyping, Wireframing, UI/UX Design, Graphic Design
- **Research**: User Research, Usability Testing, Survey Design, Competitive Analysis, Data Synthesis
- **Technical**: Python, Pandas, GitHub, Cursor, Website Building (Wix, Squarespace), AI Tools (Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini)
- **Leadership & Collaboration**: Project Management, Program Management, Communication, Collaborative Leadership